

Stirring Resolve

Patrick mulled over his options as he marked time before his turn in the Waiter Olympics. Each contestant must deliver some course of a fancy dinner to Dame Edith, who would then judge the propriety and efficacy of the interaction. Some competing waiters had chosen to bring her appetizers, like small cucumber sandwiches. Others brought dessert, like crumpets. Patrick found himself at a disadvantage. As an American, he was not familiar with the ways of British dinners. Then there was the ruin he would face if he lost the competition. While the winning prize was considerable, losers were obliged to pay a large sum, an amount that would virtually bankrupt Patrick. Perhaps, he thought, it would be prudent to drop out.

As his time approached, he found himself surrounded by reporters, asking him what would be his strategy. What course would he choose to take to Dame Edith? He considered his response to their questions and came to the realization that he had made his decision. He stood and addressed them: "I know not what course others may take, but as for me, lemme give her tea or give me debt."

